AUSTRALIAN PROPERTY MARKET DATA · RESEARCHER BRIEFING

What Is the Domain Dataset, and What Can You Do With It?

An overview of the Domain property dataset: what it contains, how it is structured, and what research it can support.

Domain API via AURIN (Australian Urban Research Infrastructure Network)

Where does this data come from, and what is in it?

Domain.com.au is one of Australia's largest property listings websites. Agents post listings there and sale results are recorded, creating a continuously updated view of the market that researchers reach through **AURIN**.

- Properties currently for sale or rent
- Properties recently sold, with price and date
- Market conditions in each suburb over time

Not a one-time snapshot. Unlike a static dataset delivered as a file, this is a **live query service**. Questions are sent and answered in real time, so the data always reflects current market activity.

📊 Suburb-Level Summaries

Market snapshots for each suburb: typical prices, how fast homes sell, rental demand, auction activity. Good for **trends, comparisons across areas, and policy analysis**.

📍 Individual Property Records

Details on specific homes: bedrooms, sold price, date, description, coordinates. Useful for **fine-grained analysis, spatial modelling, or a single street**.

Rule of thumb: if your question is about a suburb or area, use the summaries; if it is about specific properties or transactions, use the individual listings.

Suburb-Level Summaries: What's in Them?

Snapshots per suburb at quarterly, half-yearly, and annual intervals, over a rolling window of roughly the last decade. Houses and units are queried separately.

What each period record contains

- **Median sold price:** the middle sale price for the period
- **Number of sales:** how many properties actually sold
- **Days on market:** how long homes typically sat before selling
- **Auction clearance rate:** share of auctions that resulted in a sale
- **Median asking rent:** typical advertised rental price
- **Rental yield:** annual rent as a percentage of property value
- **Price distribution:** 5th, 25th, 75th, 95th percentile prices
- **Discount rate:** how much sellers typically dropped their asking price

Best for questions like...

"How have median house prices in Fitzroy changed over the last decade?"

"Which inner-Melbourne suburbs had the fastest-selling properties last year?"

"How did COVID affect rental demand in coastal areas?"

Individual Property Records: What's in Them?

Each record describes one property at one point in time (a sale, a rental listing, or an active for-sale listing).

What each property record contains

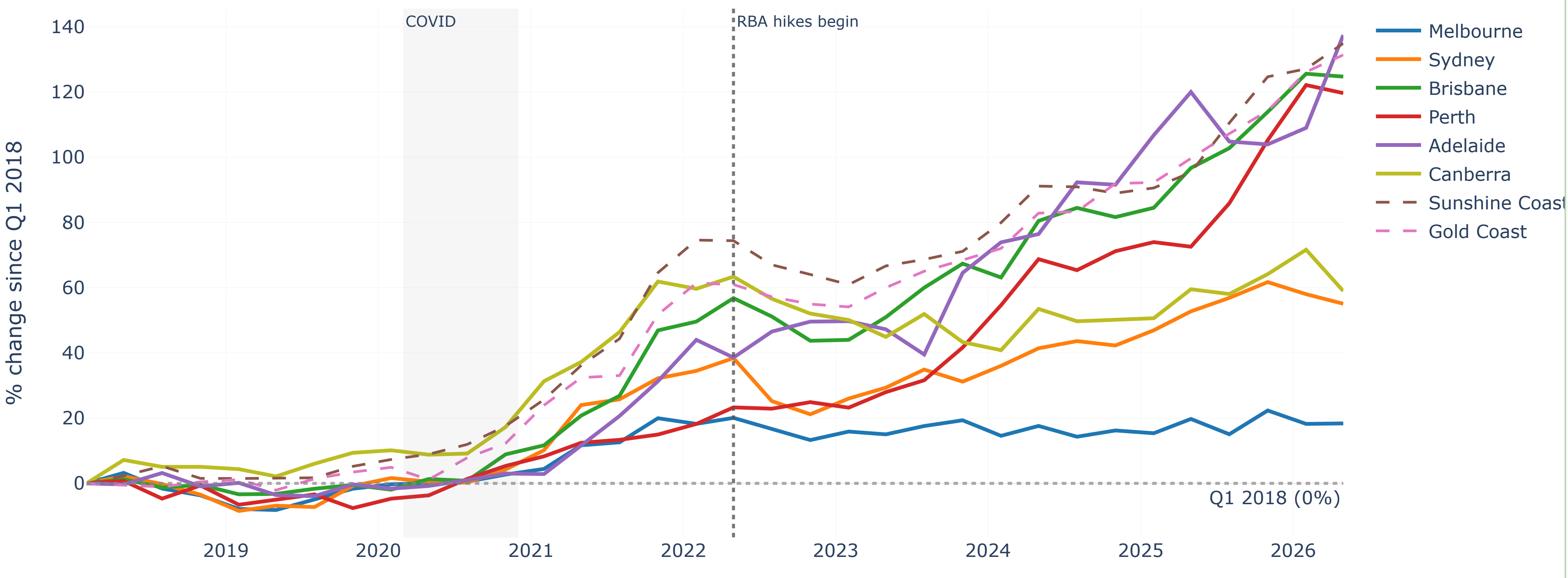
- **Address and coordinates:** exact location (lat/lon)
- **Property type:** house, apartment, townhouse, etc.
- **Size:** bedrooms, bathrooms, car spaces, land area
- **Price or rent:** sold price, asking price, or rental amount
- **Sold date:** when the transaction occurred
- **Sale method:** auction, private treaty, or expression of interest
- **Agency:** which real estate agency handled the sale
- **Features and amenities:** tags declared by the advertiser (e.g. swimming pool, air conditioning, ensuite, balcony, solar panels, water views, pet-friendly) across 41 possible attributes

⚠️ Heads up on coverage

Individual records are **densely available from 2018 onwards**. Earlier years (2000-2018) exist but the data might be sparse. Do not rely on pre-2018 completeness for research that needs every transaction.

Example: Price Trends Across Australian Markets

All markets indexed to Q1 2018, so they can be compared regardless of their absolute price levels. Capitals are solid, coastal lifestyle markets dashed.

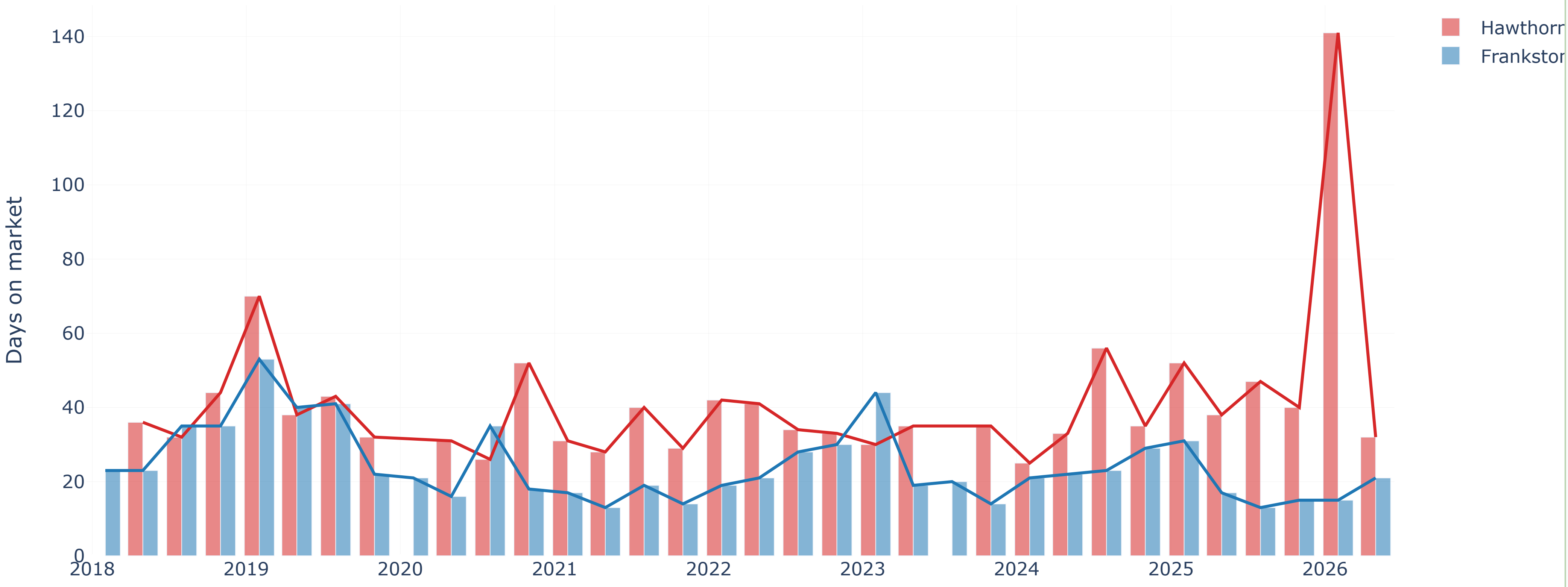


House price change since Q1 2018, eight Australian markets. Capitals shown solid, coastal lifestyle markets dashed. Click any city in the legend to hide or show it. Source: Domain API suburb performance statistics.

Built from suburb-level summary data: a sample of 30 suburbs per city spanning its price range, taken as the median of those suburb medians each quarter. Houses in Brisbane, Perth, Adelaide and both Queensland coasts roughly doubled since 2018; Sydney rose 55% and Melbourne just 18%.

Example: How Long Properties Take to Sell

"Days on market" measures how long a typical property sits before a buyer is found. A low number signals a hot market; a high number signals a buyer's market.

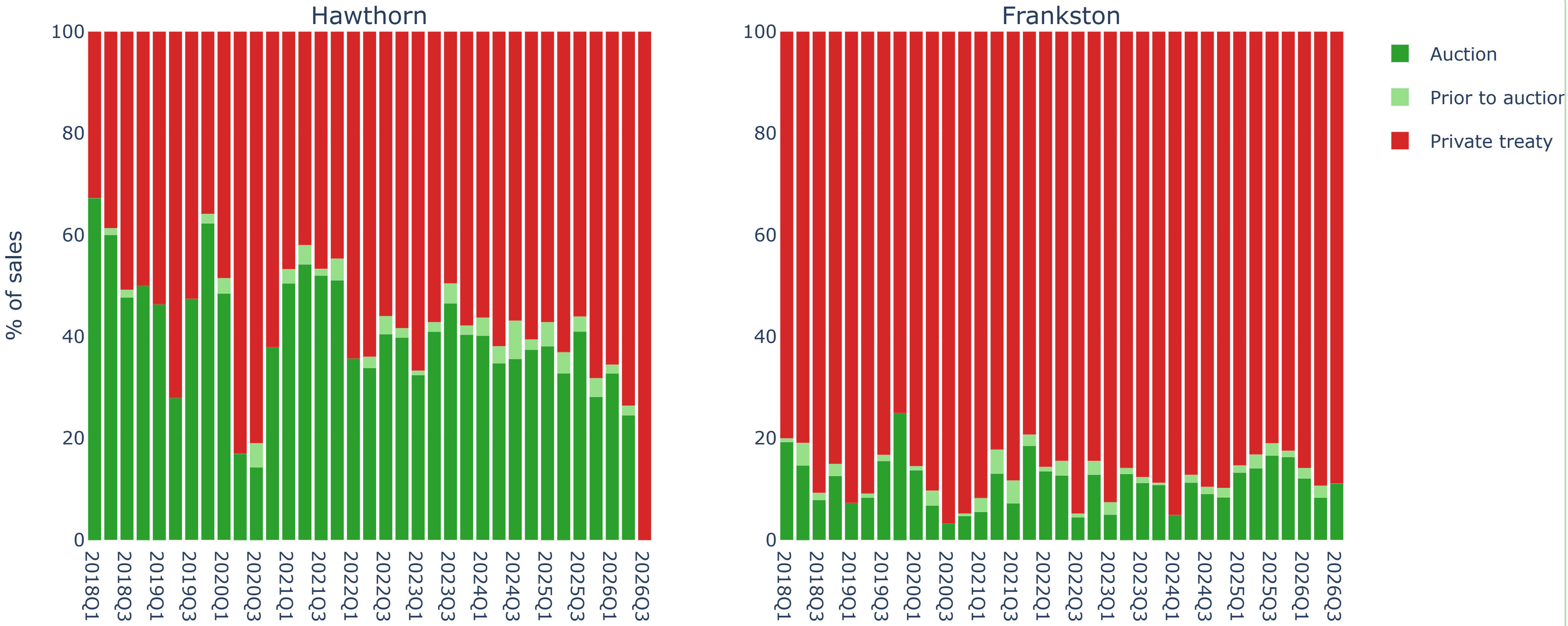


Median days on market, houses only, with trend lines. Hawthorn (inner Melbourne, premium) against Frankston (outer south-east, affordable). Source: Domain API `/v2/suburbPerformanceStatistics`.

The same suburb-level data that gives you median prices also gives you this demand signal. The reliable reading here is the gap in level between the two suburbs, not the trend within either: a Frankston house sells in about three weeks, a Hawthorn house in about five.

Example: How Properties Are Sold

The mix of auctions vs private sales shifts with market conditions and differs sharply between suburbs.



Sale method mix by quarter, as a share of all sales. Split three ways: cleared at auction, sold prior to auction, and private treaty. Click the legend to toggle a method across both suburbs. Source: Domain API residential listings endpoint.

Hawthorn leans on auctions; Frankston defaults to private treaty, where conditional contracts suit first-home buyers. Only Hawthorn's mix moves, drifting down roughly ten points after 2022, while Frankston's holds steady.

What the data covers: where, and how far back

All Australian states and territories, across every suburb with activity on Domain's platform. How far back you can go depends on which part of the dataset you need.

🗺️ All suburbs covered

Query by suburb name and postcode. Cities, regional centres and most rural areas with listing activity are included; coverage thins in very remote areas.

📐 ABS area mapping

Domain uses suburb names and postcodes, not ABS statistical areas (SA2, SA3, SA4). Correspondence files convert between the two, but it is an extra step.

📍 Spatial queries

You can draw a polygon on a map and retrieve every listing inside it. Useful for corridor studies, catchments, or irregular boundaries.

Rolling ~10 yrs — **Suburb summaries**
Quarterly, half-yearly and annual statistics over a rolling window of roughly the last decade. The most complete and reliable series.

2018 onward — **Individual listings (reliable)**
Densely covered from 2018, and suitable for transaction-level research from that point.

2000-2018 — **Individual listings (sparse)**
Records exist but many are missing. Not reliable where complete market coverage is required.

2011, 2016, 2021 — **Demographics**
Suburb-level Census profiles, available for Census years only.

How does access work?

Access is managed by AURIN and is available to approved researchers at Australian universities and research organisations.

1,000
API credits per month

1
credit per query

1st
of each month, resets

Credits are a finite monthly resource. Scoping queries around a defined research question ensures the allowance goes toward the data the study actually needs, rather than broad exploratory calls.

How a query works

- You translate a specific question (e.g., give me suburb statistics for Fitzroy, 2020-2024) to an API query.
- The system returns the data instantly and deducts from your credit balance.

🔐 Getting access

Approval through a breakthrough opportunity (or a relevant activity under your Node AAP), signing the AURIN data transfer agreement, then collecting your credentials. A full setup guide is available in the training materials.

What this data can and cannot do

A quick reference to check before designing a study around this source.

Research need	Covered?
Suburb-level price trends over the last decade	**Yes**
Individual sold property records from 2018 onwards	**Yes**
Current and recent rental listings	**Yes**
Days on market, auction rates, sale method	**Yes**
Suburb demographics (Census years)	**Yes**
Suburb statistics older than the rolling window	**No (about 10 years back)**
Complete listing records before 2018	**No (very sparse)**
Bulk download of all records for a state	**No (query by query only)**
SA2 / SA3 / SA4 aggregations out of the box	**Partial (requires a mapping step)**
Original asking price after a property has sold	**No (overwritten on sale)**
Properties not listed on Domain.com.au	**No (Domain-only market view)**

Questions?

Training materials, worked examples, and a credit cost calculator are available in the accompanying guides and Jupyter notebooks. Start with the Getting Started guide.